Prepflow

DAILY EDITION · FOR TONY DIBBIN

Wednesday, 21 October 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON	BIRMINGHAM	MANCHESTER	GLASGOW
Light rain	Light rain	Rain	Drizzle
12° 8°	11° 7°	12° 8°	10° 6°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1 **Two more people have been re-arrested in the UK on suspicion of assisting Iranian intelligence, following an incident at RAF Fairford.**

Counter Terrorism Policing say they believe Iranian state involvement is "highly likely" in the case. This comes after an earlier arrest and charge related to the incident.

NATIONAL SECURITY · UK

2 **A woman has told a court she 'couldn't speak or breathe' during an alleged rape by entertainer Russell Brand.**

Mr Brand denies three counts of rape, three charges of sexual assault and one of indecent assault. The trial continues.

COURT CASE · UK

3 **The UK is set to deploy jets to Saudi Arabia, providing defensive military support as Houthi attacks escalate in the region.**

This announcement comes amid growing concerns about stability in the Middle East. The move is intended to bolster Saudi Arabia's defences.

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS · UK

4 **Google has successfully resolved a major cloud outage that affected several UK banks and websites yesterday.**

Banking services for many Revolut customers were among the hardest hit, with users unable to access their accounts. The issue has now been fully rectified.

TECHNOLOGY · UK

5 **The Chancellor has rejected calls to raise Capital Gains Tax in the upcoming Budget, despite pressure from some influential Labour figures.**

Critics of the proposed tax hike argued it could lead to wealthy individuals leaving Britain. The decision confirms the government's stance on this key economic policy.

POLITICS · UK

02 — SHOWBIZ

What's coming up

1 **The two surviving Beatles, Sir Paul McCartney and Sir Ringo Starr, are backing plans for a new immersive visitor experience in Liverpool.**

The attraction aims to celebrate the band's legacy in their hometown. It's expected to draw fans from all over the world.

ON AIR — Are you excited about a new Beatles attraction? What's your favourite Beatles song?

MUSIC · COMING UP

2 **Rock legend Alice Cooper has been reflecting on his career, faith, and past struggles with addiction ahead of his book tour.**

He describes his stage persona as a character, like 'Jekyll and Hyde'. Alice Cooper will be appearing in Wolverhampton.

ON AIR — Alice Cooper is coming to the UK! What's your favourite classic rock anthem?

MUSIC · COMING UP

3 **Previously unseen clips from the classic sitcom Only Fools and Horses are set to feature in a new show about the series.**

The footage, shot during the making of 'The Jolly Boys' Outing' episode, promises to add new depth for fans. It's a treat for anyone who loves Del Boy and Rodney.

ON AIR — More Only Fools and Horses! What's your all-time favourite episode?

TV · COMING UP

4 **Apu from The Simpsons is reportedly returning to the show with a new voice, after an eight-year absence from speaking roles.**

The much-loved Kwik-E-Mart owner has been seen in Springfield but hasn't had any lines since a race row. Fans will be keen to hear his return.

ON AIR — Apu is back in The Simpsons! Who's your favourite character from the show?

TV · COMING UP

5 **The new 'Street Fighter' movie is being hailed as a film 'made by fans for fans', as cast members discuss the latest video game adaptation.**

Noah Centineo, Andrew Koji, and Callina Liang star in the new big-screen version. It’s hoping to be a knockout with critics and audiences alike.

ON AIR — Are you excited for the new Street Fighter movie? What's your favourite video game adaptation?

FILM · COMING UP

03 — SPORT

On the schedule

1 **England's winter cricket tour has started with a disappointing loss to Pakistan in the one-day tri-series in Rawalpindi.**

It was a sloppy performance from England, who will be looking to bounce back quickly. They'll need to improve as the series progresses.

ON AIR — A tough start for England in Pakistan. What do they need to do to turn things around?

CRICKET · UK

2 **Former Manchester United manager Erik ten Hag has claimed Cristiano Ronaldo 'let the team and let me down' during his time at Old Trafford.**

Ten Hag was speaking about Ronaldo's departure during his spell as manager. It reignites the debate about the star player's impact on the club.

ON AIR — Do you agree with Erik ten Hag's comments about Cristiano Ronaldo at Manchester United?

FOOTBALL · UK

3 **Northern Ireland's Mark Allen has admitted he is 'contemplating retirement' from snooker after his exit from the Northern Ireland Open.**

Allen lost 4-2 to Jordan Brown in a surprising defeat. He said the thought of retiring has been on his mind for a while.

ON AIR — Could we see Mark Allen retire from snooker? What do you think he should do?

SNOOKER · UK

4 **Tottenham Hotspur have secured their first Premier League win of the season, beating Coventry City at home to move off the bottom of the table.**

It was a much-needed victory for Spurs, who have had a difficult start to the campaign. The win will boost confidence in the squad.

ON AIR — Spurs finally have a win! Can they build on this and climb up the table?

FOOTBALL · UK

5 **Britain's Katie Boulter has produced an emphatic win in her first-round match at the Japan Open, despite a rain delay.**

Boulter claimed a dominant victory against Himeno Sakatsume. It's a strong start for the British player in the tournament.

ON AIR — Great start for Katie Boulter in Japan! Who are you backing in the tennis this week?

TENNIS · UK

04 — NEWSBRIEF

Quick hits

1 **The joy of finding an unexpectedly deep pocket in your clothes is being celebrated by fashionistas and practical folk alike.**

It's a small but mighty victory, offering a secure home for keys, phone, or even an emergency biscuit. Who knew such a simple design feature could bring so much delight?

2 **A new appreciation for the humble 'doorstop' is gaining traction, with collectors seeking out vintage and quirky designs.**

No longer just a functional item, these often-overlooked household essentials are becoming a surprisingly charming decorative feature. From cast iron animals to intricately carved wooden pieces, there's a doorstop for every taste.

3 **The satisfying 'clink of a glass bottle' being placed in a recycling bin is a newly recognised sound of domestic contentment.**

It's the auditory signal of a job well done, contributing to both a tidy home and a greener planet. That little chime can really boost your mood, can't it?

4 **Experts are highlighting the calming effect of 'watching a small, steady flame', like a candle or a gas hob.**

There's something uniquely hypnotic and peaceful about its gentle dance. It's a simple, ancient pleasure that can help unwind a busy mind at the end of the day.

5 **The delightful practice of 'naming your houseplants' is reportedly on the rise, fostering a deeper connection with indoor greenery.**

From 'Ferdinand the Fern' to 'Polly the Pothos', giving your leafy companions a moniker seems to encourage better care and adds a touch of personality to your home. Who's your favourite houseplant?

6 **A new trend sees people enjoying 'the perfect sandwich crust' as a moment of mindful eating.**

It's often overlooked, but the texture and slight crisp of a well-made crust can be a delicious highlight of any sandwich. Savoring that final bite is a small pleasure many are now embracing.

7 **The comforting ritual of 'tucking in a loose thread' on a piece of clothing is being recognised for its small but significant sense of order.**

That little flick of the finger, pulling a stray thread back into place, brings a tiny moment of satisfaction. It’s a subtle act of tidiness that just feels right.

05 — TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q **Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to quietly 'doing' what when trying to decide if a new brand of chocolate will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific? What is it?**

ANSWER: SMELLING IT VERY INTENTLY, OFTEN WITH A LITTLE SNIFF NEAR THE WRAPPER.

Q **Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to having a particular 'odd routine' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, new jar of jam, especially if it's a fancy, artisan one. What is it?**

ANSWER: LICKING THE TINY BIT OF JAM OFF THE INSIDE OF THE LID, JUST A LITTLE TASTE TEST.

TALK TOPIC

- **You know how sometimes a particular 'everyday pattern' just catches your eye – maybe the way a shadow falls, or the arrangement of items on a shelf, or even the brickwork on a building?**
  What's an everyday pattern or design that you've noticed recently that you found surprisingly pleasing or interesting? Maybe it's the tiling in your kitchen, or the way the bubbles settle in your cup of tea!

- **We all have that 'one small, everyday household item' that, for some reason, we're surprisingly protective of or attached to, even if it's just a favourite mug or a well-loved spatula.**
  What's an everyday item in your home that you'd be surprisingly upset if it went missing or got broken? What makes it so special to you?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY — LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Nature.** Did you know that a group of owls is actually called a 'parliament'?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Did you know that the iconic British red telephone boxes were originally designed to be green?

Prepflow

06 — LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£25 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 — FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The distinctive sound of Big Ben's chimes is officially known as the 'Westminster Quarters'.
- The first crossword puzzle was published in a newspaper in New York in 1913.
- Honey never spoils and can be safe to eat even after thousands of years.
- The only letter in the alphabet that does not appear in the name of any U.S. state is 'Q'.
- The 'king' of playing cards is the only one without a moustache.
- A pineapple is not a single fruit, but rather a collection of many individual berries fused together.
- The world's oldest known living tree, 'Methuselah', is a Great Basin bristlecone pine over 4,800 years old.
- The inventor of the Pringle's can is buried in one.

08 — TODAY'S DAY NOTES WED 21 OCT 2026

On this day

Day 294 of the year, 71 days left in 2026. Today Armed Forces Day (Honduras); Christian feast day: Céline of Laon; Christian feast day: Blessed Charles of Austria (Roman Catholic Church); Christian feast day: Fintán of Taghmon. Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1940 — Geoffrey Boycott, English cricketer and sportscaster
- 1991 — Harry Pell, English footballer
- 1978 — Will Estes, American actor
- 1976 — Josh Ritter, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1991 — Rob Keogh, English cricketer
- 1943 — Ron Elliott, American singer-songwriter, guitarist, and composer
- 1959 — Melora Walters, American actress, director, and writer
- 1980 — Brian Pittman, American bass player

THE DAY TODAY

- 1973 — Fred Dryer of the Los Angeles Rams becomes the first player in NFL history to score two safeties in the same game.
- 1979 — Moshe Dayan resigns from the Israeli government because of strong disagreements with Prime Minister Menachem Begin over policy towards the Arabs.
- 1994 — North Korea and the United States sign an Agreed Framework that requires North Korea to stop its nuclear weapons program and agree to inspections.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1971 — A gas explosion kills 22 people at a shopping centre near Glasgow, Scotland.
- 2021 — A shooting occurs on the set of the film Rust, in which actor Alec Baldwin discharged a prop weapon which had been loaded, killing the director of photography, Halyna Hutchins, and injuring director Joel Souza.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1950 — Korean War: Heavy fighting begins between British and Australian forces and North Koreans during the Battle of Yongju.

- 1969 — The 1969 Somali coup d'état establishes a Marxist–Leninist administration.
- 1967 — The National Mobilization Committee to End the War in Vietnam organizes a march of fifty thousand people from the Lincoln Memorial to the Pentagon.

09 — TOMORROW'S DAY NOTES THU 22 OCT 2026

A peek at tomorrow

Day 295 of the year, 70 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Abercius of Hieropolis; Christian feast day: Cordula of Cologne; Christian feast day: Donatus of Fiesole; Christian feast day: Marcus of Jerusalem. Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1968 — Shelby Lynne, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1986 — Chancellor, South Korean-American musician
- 1992 — Sofia Vassilieva, American actress
- 1958 — Bobby Blotzer, American drummer
- 1990 — Jonathan Lipnicki, American actor
- 1949 — Stiv Bators, American singer-songwriter, guitarist, and actor (died 1990)
- 1981 — Michael Fishman, American actor and producer
- 1980 — Niall Breslin, Irish singer-songwriter, guitarist, producer, and footballer

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 2007 — A raid on Anuradhapura Air Force Base is carried out by 21 Tamil Tiger commandos, with all except one dying in this attack. Eight Sri Lanka Air Force planes are destroyed and ten damaged.
- 1987 — John Adams' opera Nixon in China premiered at the Houston Grand Opera.
- 1999 — Maurice Papon, an official in the Vichy government during World War II, is jailed for crimes against humanity.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 2005 — Bellview Airlines Flight 210 crashes in Nigeria, killing all 117 people on board.
- 2008 — India launches its first uncrewed lunar probe mission Chandrayaan-1.

10 — FORWARD PLANNING · FILM

Coming to cinemas

OCTOBER 2026 · PREVIEW

FRI 23 Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING · SPORT

On the sporting calendar

Edition: Wed 21 Oct 2026
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